Seerah of the Prophet ﷺ

Why Study Seerah?

1. Knowing the meaning of Seerah.
2. Knowing why knowing the why of anything you do is important.
    a. You can decide whether you want to do it or not.
    b. You realize how important it is to you.
    c. You develop the zeal required to do it.
    d. You can identify the end result and aspire hard to do it.

1. **Loving the Prophet ﷺ is an essential part of faith** and you cannot love someone without knowing about him. It is a closed loop, the more you love the more you study and the more you study the more you love.

فَوَ الَّذِيْ نَفْسِيْ بِيَدِهٖ لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتّٰي أَكُوْنَ أَحَبَّ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ وَالِدِهٖ وَوَلَدِهٖ

صحيح البخاري،كتاب الإيمان،باب حب الرسول صلي الله عليه وسلم من الايمان ، رقم الحديث ١٤،١،٥٨.

"By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, none of you truly believes until I am more beloved to him than his father and his child."

2. The Qur'an commands us to **follow the Prophet ﷺ**. So how can one follow someone if he doesn't know him?!

قُلْ أَطِيعُوا ٱللَّهَ وَٱلرَّسُولَ

"Say, 'Obey Allah and the Messenger.'"

(3:32)

3. It shows us how to live **a life which is pleasing to Allah** in all aspects of our life, including our:
    a. Personal life (with parents, with children, with wives),
    b. Social life (with relatives, with neighbors, with general masses),
    c. Connection with Allah,
    d. Interaction with inanimate things/beings,
    e. Interaction with people of other religions,
    f. Political interactions.

وَإِنَّكَ لَعَلَىٰ خُلُقٍ عَظِيمٍ

"And indeed, you are truly a man of outstanding character."

(68:4)

4. You **cannot understand Qur'an without knowing the life of the Prophet ﷺ** as the Qur'an revolves around his ﷺ life and the events which took place during his ﷺ lifetime. Here are some of the examples:

    a. Surah ad-Duha.
    b. Surah al-Kauthar.

5. Seerah **affirms our eman/increases optimism** and raises optimism as we get to know that there were people who were tested with regards to their faith more so than us in every aspect.

وَكُلًّا نَّقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ مِنْ أَنۢبَآءِ ٱلرُّسُلِ مَا نُثَبِّتُ بِهِۦ فُؤَادَكَ ۚ وَجَآءَكَ فِى هَٰذِهِ ٱلْحَقُّ وَمَوْعِظَةٌ وَذِكْرَىٰ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ

"And We relate to you all the stories of the messengers by which We strengthen your heart. And there has come to you in this ˹Surah˺ the truth, a lesson, and a reminder for the believers."

(11:120)

Death of Ibrahim, the son the Prophet ﷺ
Arrival of the Prophet ﷺ in Madinah after the battle of Badr and realizing that his ﷺ daughter had passed away
Lost his loved ones, one by one
Had problems with wives

6. It is a **sign that you love Allah**. How can you love Allah without loving the one whom Allah loves the most from His creation?

قُلْ إِن كُنتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ ٱللَّهَ فَٱتَّبِعُونِى يُحْبِبْكُمُ ٱللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ

"Say, 'If you truly love Allah, then follow me; Allah will love you and forgive your sins.'"

(3:31)

أفلا أكُونُ عَبْدًا شَكُورًا

"Should I not then be a grateful servant?"

Bukhari: 4557

7. It is a **means to dive into the lives of the best people** to walk on the face of this earth and learn from them.

فَإِنْ ءَامَنُوا۟ بِمِثْلِ مَآ ءَامَنتُم بِهِۦ فَقَدِ ٱهْتَدَوا۟ ۖ وَّإِن تَوَلَّوْا۟ فَإِنَّمَا هُمْ فِى شِقَاقٍ ۖ فَسَيَكْفِيكَهُمُ ٱللَّهُ ۚ وَهُوَ ٱلسَّمِيعُ ٱلْعَلِيمُ

"So if they believe in the same as you believe, then they will have been rightly guided. But if they turn away, then they are only in opposition. Allah will be sufficient for you against them. And He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing."

(2:137)

Khabbab ibn al-Arat's suffering at the hands of his mistress Umm-e-Anmar

8. The Prophet ﷺ should be the **role model** of every single Muslim. How can we have a role model regarding whom we don't know how he ﷺ spent his life.

لَّقَدْ كَانَ لَكُمْ فِى رَسُولِ ٱللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ لِّمَن كَانَ يَرْجُوا۟ ٱللَّهَ وَٱلْيَوْمَ ٱلْـَٔاخِرَ وَذَكَرَ ٱللَّهَ كَثِيرًا

"Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent example for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day and remembers Allah often."

(33:21)

9. It is a form of **worship**.
10. Without studying the seerah, **we cannot defend the honor of our beloved Prophet ﷺ**

إِنَّ رُوحَ الْقُدُسِ لاَ يَزَالُ يُؤَيِّدُكَ مَا نَافَحْتَ عَنِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ

"Indeed, the Holy Spirit will continue to support you as long as you defend Allah and His Messenger."

Sahih Muslim: 2490

LINEAGE OF THE PROPHET ﷺ

1. Lineage of the Prophet ﷺ can be divided into three categories:
   a. From Prophet ﷺ to Adnan is agreed upon,
   b. From Adnan to Ibraheem various disagreements (obviously, we are not certain),
   c. From Ibraheem to Adam, we don't know for sure.
2. **Virtues** of the lineage of the Prophet ﷺ
   a. Best of the generations:
      i. He himself informed us.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ ـ رضى الله عنه ـ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صلى الله عليه وسلم قَالَ " بُعِثْتُ مِنْ خَيْرِ قُرُونِ بَنِي آدَمَ قَرْنًا فَقَرْنًا، حَتَّى كُنْتُ مِنَ الْقَرْنِ الَّذِي كُنْتُ فِيهِ"

"I was sent from the best generations of the children of Adam, generation after generation, until I appeared in the generation in which I am."

(Bukhari: 3557)

ii. When Heraclius, the Roman emperor, asked Abu Sufyan questions relating to the qualities of the Prophet (SAAS), he wanted to know how good his lineage was in his people. Abu Sufyan replied, "He does indeed have good lineage in us."

iii. His progeny continued through legal marriages all the way from Adam to him ﷺ

   b. From which tribes Allah chose the Prophet ﷺ

" إِنَّ اللَّهَ اصْطَفَى كِنَانَةَ مِنْ وَلَدِ إِسْمَاعِيلَ وَاصْطَفَى قُرَيْشًا مِنْ كِنَانَةَ وَاصْطَفَى مِنْ قُرَيْشٍ بَنِي هَاشِمٍ وَاصْطَفَانِي مِنْ بَنِي هَاشِمٍ

"Indeed, Allah chose Kinānah from among the descendants of Ismāʿīl, chose Quraysh from Kinānah, chose Banū Hāshim from Quraysh, and chose me from Banū Hāshim."

(Muslim: 2276)

3. He had six paternal aunts and nine, ten or tweleve uncles.
4. He had no maternal uncles and aunts as Aminah was the only daughter of her parents.

5. All the people of Quraish were related to the Prophet ﷺ in one way or the other as narrated by Ibn-e-Abbas in the tafseer of the verse:

قُل لَّآ أَسۡـَٔلُكُمۡ عَلَيۡهِ أَجۡرًا إِلَّا ٱلۡمَوَدَّةَ فِى ٱلۡقُرۡبَىٰ

Say, ˹O Prophet,˺ "I do not ask you for a reward for this ˹message˺—only honour for ˹our˺ kinship."

(40:23)